

Muhammad Zubair Zafar

San Francisco, CA | (217) 790 8056 | zubairzafar480@gmail.com | github.com/zubair480 | linkedin.com/in/zubair480

Founding engineer building LLM agents with eval harnesses that hold up under attack. Full-stack in Python and TypeScript. 6x hackathon winner.

EXPERIENCE

Founding Engineer, Andever AI (Stealth)

San Francisco, CA | Jun 2026 – Present

- Sole engineer at a longevity-AI startup, working directly with the founder, investors and prospective customers.
- Built the core loop in Python: an agent proposes interventions and an eval harness scores each one's modelled effect on 12 published epigenetic clocks, holding 3 clocks out of the reward on alternating rounds to catch reward gaming.
- Put two agents behind one interface: an LLM agent (structured output, full scored history in context) and an offline optimizer that assigns credit by ridge regression, so the loop improves with or without an API key.
- Cut the scoring service from 803 MB to 88 MB and an 8-iteration run from 9.5 s to 0.08 s by precomputing the clock panel at build time, so it fits a 512 MB instance.

Software Engineer (Graduate Assistant), Eastern Illinois University

Charleston, IL | Aug 2024 – May 2026

- Shipped a Laravel HR system for 7,000+ users and cut API response time 65% through query tuning and indexing.
- Automated request workflows with Twilio SMS and REST APIs, reducing manual entry 40% and speeding request processing 25%.
- Rewrote a 2006-era PHP application from the ground up in Laravel. Reliability rose 35% after the migration.

Backend Software Engineer, WPBrigade

Dec 2023 – Aug 2024

- Developed and maintained 5+ production plugins with 15,000+ combined active installs, including custom REST API endpoints, webhook integrations and database schema optimization.
- Wrote a PHP theme framework that lets 200+ non-technical users build sites without code. Deployment time fell 60%.

Software Engineering Intern, Etihad Aviation Group

Abu Dhabi, UAE | Sep 2023 – Oct 2023

- Turned a hackathon-winning IATA cargo message (CPM) parser into a production tool (Python, Flask, regex). Manual processing fell 30% and data-entry errors 95%.

RESEARCH

Graduate Research Assistant, Eastern Illinois University

Charleston, IL | Aug 2025 – May 2026

- Trained YOLOv8 classifiers in PyTorch on 80,000+ labeled MRI scans, reaching 97.2% test accuracy and 95.8% F1.
- Built preprocessing and augmentation (rotation, flip, scale) and moved training to Colab Pro GPUs, cutting training time 70%.

SELECTED PROJECTS

28 projects at zubair480.github.io/projects

RefundGuard | 2nd place, The Executable World hackathon, SF | [GitHub](#) | [Live report](#)

Sep 2026

- Built a release gate that attacks an AI refund agent with 11 scam personas and 3 honest controls, scoring each run by ledger replay in code plus a quote-verified LLM judge. Version 1 leaked \$310 and promised \$709 in writing. By version 3, 0 of 11 attacks breached.

Attest | 2nd place, solo, Agent Native Builders at Cloudflare SF | [GitHub](#)

Aug 2026

- Agent-to-agent vendor security review (separate Cotal agents and credentials) that accepts only evidence-backed answers. Each claim passes a deterministic severity counter and an LLM relevance judge, and disagreements escalate to a person.

EstateAgent AI | HackIllinois 2026 | [GitHub](#) | [Live demo](#)

Mar 2026

- Built a map-reduce agent pipeline on Modal with parallel analyst agents (Qwen 2.5 on vLLM, H100s) and FastAPI. Streamed progress over WebSockets on Cloudflare Durable Objects and ran 5,000 Monte Carlo simulations in under 12 s.

PayeeLock | AI Security Hackathon SF | [GitHub](#)

Sep 2026

- Defense for an AI accounts-payable agent against business email compromise: agent-written Python runs in a Wasmer sandbox with no network, and a ledger that never reads email decides payments. Paid a real \$48,250 invoice, blocked the spoofed one.

ROOT | 2nd place, CrewAI Hackathon, team | [LinkedIn post](#)

2026

- Team build of a 14-agent CrewAI system that reads a Zendesk onboarding request and provisions software, hardware and access, cutting a week of provisioning to minutes.

SKILLS

AI / ML: LLM agents (CrewAI, LangGraph, MCP), evals, LLM-as-judge, RAG, LLM APIs (OpenAI, Anthropic), PyTorch

Full stack: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, PHP, FastAPI, Flask, Node.js, React, Next.js, Laravel, REST APIs, WebSockets, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Neo4j, Redis

Infra and tools: Docker, CI/CD, Cloudflare Workers and Durable Objects, Modal GPUs, Supabase, Convex, Wasmer sandboxing, Claude Code and Codex, automated tests

EDUCATION

M.S. Computer Information Technology, Eastern Illinois University | GPA 4.0 | Fully funded scholarship Aug 2024 – May 2026

B.S. Computer Science, Government College University Faisalabad

Oct 2019 – Sep 2023

Hackathon wins: 1st place, Amadeus (Etihad challenge). 2nd place at Agent Native Builders at Cloudflare (solo), The Executable World, CrewAI (team), Auth0 x Stripe at Okta (team) and B.E.L.L.E, Neo4j and Qoder prizes (team). Qualcomm Special Prize (team).

Teaching: Section Leader, Stanford Code in Place (CS106A), 3 cycles, 2023 – 2025, selected from thousands of applicants.